You said:

Give me a scaffolding for a 20-minute lesson for prospective high school students who are coming to visit our program on Friday morning for Prelude Day. I'm supposed to teach a couple of breakout sessions here for a group of potentially interested theory and composition students, introducing them to Music Theory I type materials. And one of the possible topics that's been given is on modes, and I'd like to maybe discuss modes in terms of church modes, but also in terms of jazz. And I need some ideas of where to start and how to divide the time. Let me just double check. I think it's basically a 20-minute presentation, but I want to confirm that real quick. It could be on triads, modes, something to get them interested and excited about studying theory a little more. Yeah, it looks like it's supposed to be 20 minutes exactly.

ChatGPT said:

I'd build the session around **"Same Notes, Different Home: Hearing Modes."** It gives students a concrete listening experience, connects older modal terminology with jazz, and lets you introduce theory as a way to explain something they can already hear.

The central question: **How can the same collection of notes produce different musical characters?** Keep the session focused on major and Dorian, with Mixolydian as a brief extension.

Time	Activity	Teaching purpose
0:00–2:00	Play a short, upbeat phrase in C major. Then play a phrase using the same white notes over a sustained D bass. Ask: "What changed? What seems like home?"	Establish the difference between a collection of notes and a tonal center.
2:00–5:00	Display C–D–E–F–G–A–B and D–E–F–G–A–B–C. Explain that the notes are identical, but their relationships to "home" change. Have students sing or hum D while you play the Dorian phrase.	Introduce a mode as an organization of pitches around a center. Emphasize that merely starting a scale on D does not establish D as home.
5:00–8:00	Compare **D natural minor** with **D Dorian**: play a short melody first with B♭, then with B♮, over the same D drone. Ask which note changed and what effect it had.	Give students a useful handle: Dorian is minor with a raised sixth. Accept varied descriptions of its character.

Time	Activity	Teaching purpose
8:00–11:00	Give the historical connection in about one minute, then play a short D-centered, chant-like melody. Explain that names such as Dorian belong to a long history of modal classification; jazz later uses these names within different musical practices.	Connect “church modes” and jazz without implying that medieval chant and jazz use modes identically.
11:00–15:00	Introduce Miles Davis’s **“So What.”** Play a prepared excerpt from the opening D-minor portion of the head or solo section. Ask students to listen for a stable home and the space available for rhythmic and melodic invention. Demonstrate a D Dorian line yourself afterward.	Show how a mode can provide an extended field for improvisation, rather than requiring a new chord every few beats.
15:00–18:00	Make a tiny piece together. Invite students to choose the order of **D–F–A–B**, then choose a rhythm. Play their motive over D. Change B to B♭ and repeat. If comfortable, invite volunteers to sing or improvise a response.	Let students make compositional decisions and hear how one pitch changes the result.
18:00–20:00	Briefly demonstrate D Mixolydian by changing F to F♯ while retaining C♮. Then return to the main question: “What tells us where home is?” End by replaying the student-created motive.	Broaden the idea and close with something they helped create.

For your board or slide, I’d use **parallel modes on D**, after the initial white-note demonstration. This makes the differences much easier to hear and see:

Mode	Notes	Useful comparison
D natural minor / Aeolian	D E F G A B♭ C	Familiar minor reference
D Dorian	D E F G A B C	Minor with a raised sixth
D Mixolydian	D E F♯ G A B C	Major with a lowered seventh

A possible opening:

> “I’m going to play two little musical ideas using exactly the same notes. Your job is to decide whether they feel like they belong to the same musical world—and to listen for the note that feels like home.”

For the historical minute, something like:

> “You may have heard the expression ‘church modes.’ Medieval church musicians classified melodies partly by their final, or home note, their range, and characteristic melodic behavior. Jazz musicians use some of the same modal names, but in a different setting: a mode can become a pitch environment for improvisation over a sustained harmony. Today we’re exploring one connection between these traditions: how music establishes a center and gives the surrounding notes particular roles.”

The main thing I’d avoid is teaching all seven modes. In twenty minutes, hearing Dorian clearly, changing one note, and making a musical decision will be more memorable than learning seven names. If time runs short, drop Mixolydian and preserve the student composition activity.

You need only a keyboard, one board or slide, and a queued audio excerpt. Keep volunteer performance optional so students with different levels of experience can participate.

The attached “Ordering Course materials.docx” did not come through; please upload it again if you intended it to inform this lesson.

You said:

what coltrane or other tunes are in d dorian? what other modal jazz? i know so what is in d dorian.

Worked for 24s

ChatGPT said:

Coltrane’s “Impressions” is the clearest next example. It uses the same modal form as “So What”: **16 bars D Dorian → 8 bars E♭ Dorian → 8 bars D Dorian.** So both are predominantly D Dorian, with a contrasting section a half step higher. “Impressions” gives you a much faster, more driving treatment of that same framework. chord progressio… +1

For other modal jazz, I’d distinguish these:

Tune	Modal material	Potential use in your lesson
Coltrane, “My Favorite Things”	Extended **E Dorian** and **E major** passages in his arrangement; the melody also introduces other pitches.	A familiar melody transformed through modal improvisation; useful for comparing minor and major colors over the same center.
Herbie Hancock, “Maiden Voyage”	Sustained **suspended-chord areas**, beginning on D and moving to other centers.	Shows that modal jazz also involves distinctive harmony, texture, and rhythm—not just running a scale.
Miles Davis, “Flamenco Sketches”	A succession of five modal areas.	A broader example of moving between pitch environments rather than following rapidly changing functional chords.

These are established modal examples, but I wouldn’t label any of those three simply “a tune in D Dorian.” Ethan teaches yo… +2

For Friday, I’d pair “So What” with “Impressions.” Play twenty or thirty seconds of each and ask: *“These use the same modes and the same harmonic plan. What makes them sound so different?”* That opens up tempo, groove, articulation, melodic shape, and interaction—and demonstrates how much compositional possibility exists within a small amount of pitch material.

One useful qualification for students: **D Dorian describes the underlying framework; it doesn’t mean the improvisers restrict themselves to its seven notes.**

You said:

examples of jazz and pop music for phrygian mode?

Worked for 24s

ChatGPT said:

For your lesson, Pink Floyd’s “Set the Controls for the Heart of the Sun” is a particularly clear example. Jazz examples tend to mix Phrygian with other collections, so I’d identify a specific passage or feature.

Example	What to listen for	Qualification
Pink Floyd, “Set the Controls for the Heart of the Sun”	The vocal figure **E–F–E–D–E** makes the half step above home unmistakable. It later moves to **A–B♭–A–G–A**.	Excellent for demonstrating E Phrygian and its transposition to A Phrygian. blog.discmakers....
Beyoncé, “I Care”	The flattened second gives the minor-centered material its Phrygian color.	A contemporary pop example; best presented as Phrygian-inflected rather than claiming every passage stays within one scale. becomeaprocom...
“Nardis,” especially Bill Evans’s recordings	The prominent **E/F relationship** gives the tune a strong Phrygian character.	Its melody also uses other pitches and Spanish Phrygian colors; it is more complex than a single-mode exercise. Playback with Le...
Miles Davis, “Flamenco Sketches”	The fourth modal area centers on **D**, with **E♭** immediately above it.	The performance includes major-third coloring, so this passage also introduces **Phrygian dominant**. The whole tune cycles through five modal areas. italianpiano.com +1

The distinction to keep clear:

- **E Phrygian:** E F **G** A B C D — minor third.
- **E Phrygian dominant:** E F **G♯** A B C D — major third.

For Friday, use the Pink Floyd vocal figure: play **E–F♯–E–D–E**, then **E–F–E–D–E** over an E drone. Students hear immediately what lowering scale degree 2 does. You can then connect that sound to the recording without needing to teach additional harmony.

You said:

what about messaien's modes of limited transposition? typcically not taught to high schoolers but i'd like to icorporate a preview if possible!

ChatGPT said:

Yes—**Messiaen could make a great two-minute “where this can lead” ending.** Students don’t need advanced theory to hear the effect or discover the underlying pattern.

The connection is: **we've changed the musical possibilities by reorganizing familiar notes; what happens when we change the pitch collection itself?**

I'd introduce his **Mode 1, the whole-tone scale**, rather than survey all seven modes:

Time	What you do	What students discover
0:00–0:30	Play C–D–E–F♯–G♯–A♯–C, then a short, floating improvisation using those notes.	A collection with only whole steps sounds different from major, Dorian, or Phrygian.
0:30–1:15	Move the scale up one semitone. Then move it up another semitone and compare its notes with the original.	The second move returns to the original **pitch collection**, starting on a different note.
1:15–2:00	Name the phenomenon and let students choose a few notes for a tiny motive.	They have heard, understood, and composed with a mode of limited transposition.

You can put just these three lines on the board:

- **Starting collection:** C D E F♯ G♯ A♯
- **Up one semitone:** D♭ E♭ F G A B
- **Up two semitones:** D E F♯ G♯ A♯ C — the original collection again.

"Limited transposition" means **there are only a few distinct transpositions before the same collection returns**. For the whole-tone scale, there are only two. The repeating interval pattern creates this symmetry.

A possible spoken introduction:

> "The composer Olivier Messiaen was fascinated by scales whose patterns repeat so evenly that moving them to a new pitch can give you the same notes again. He called these modes of limited transposition. Let's see how many different whole-tone collections we can find before we repeat ourselves."

If you want a slightly more surprising alternative, use Mode 2, the octatonic scale: alternate half steps and whole steps:

C–D♭–E♭–E–F♯–G–A–B♭–C.

Move it up three semitones and the collection returns; it has **three distinct transpositions**. This also gives you a connection to jazz's diminished scales. I'd choose **either whole-tone or octatonic** for this short preview.

One conceptual distinction to mention: **Messiaen's "modes" are special pitch collections; they don't work exactly like the church modes, where you've been emphasizing different centers within a diatonic collection.** Also, he catalogued and developed these resources extensively; he didn't invent the whole-tone or octatonic scales.

For your twenty minutes, I'd reserve **minutes 17–19 for this discovery**, then close with: *"Theory can help us understand familiar music—and invent musical worlds we haven't heard yet."*

You said:

The problem is that nardis uses a leading tone and it's not firmly in Phrygian mode. Fiona apple's love ridden may be a nice compliment to this; it uses leading tones but not as prominently.

ChatGPT said:

Yes—my earlier suggestion of **"Nardis" was too loose for an introductory Phrygian example.** Its leading tone and other chromatic pitches complicate the claim that it inhabits one mode. A prominent ♭2 alone doesn't establish Phrygian.

"Love Ridden" could make a useful complement precisely because of that tension: you could distinguish a prevailing modal color from occasional pitches that create stronger directional motion. Your observation about the less prominent leading tones gives students a listening question: *"Does this altered note change our sense of the musical world, or briefly pull us toward home?"*

For the twenty-minute session, I'd sequence it this way:

- **Establish the sound:** E drone, then E–F–G–A–B–C–D. Emphasize F resolving to E.
- **Hear a clear example:** the principal vocal figure from Pink Floyd's "Set the Controls."
- **Complicate the model:** a short passage from "Love Ridden," asking students to notice where the music departs from the collection.

That lets you introduce **modes as audible frameworks that composers can inflect**, while giving students a clear reference before introducing exceptions. "Nardis" would be better saved for a later discussion of the overlap between modal color and tonal harmony.

You said:

can you find a website that i think was a github project consisting of a large lexicon of musical scales and sets?

Worked for 12s >

ChatGPT said:

My strongest guess is Ian Ring's A Study of Scales / The Exciting Universe of Music Theory**.** It's a large catalogue connecting scales with pitch-class sets, featuring circular "bracelet" diagrams, numerical identifiers, modal relationships, prime forms, and symmetry. If you remember individual scales having long pages of properties and alternative names, this is likely it. ianring.com

Two other possibilities that fit the GitHub detail:

- Scales, by Michael Racette — an interactive scale visualization website hosted on GitHub Pages. reddit.com
- Music Theory Data, by Sean Colsen — a large dictionary of scales, chords, and intervals, drawing many scale names from Francesco Balena's *The Scale Omnibus*. This is more a data repository than an encyclopedia-style website. GitHub

Do you remember **circular pitch diagrams, a piano keyboard, or a long searchable list of scale names**? That would help narrow it down.

You said:

take me through the modes of the harmonic minor scale as taught in jazz. is there another minor scale that is used in jazz theory?

Worked for 14s >

ChatGPT said:

Yes—**melodic minor is the other essential minor-scale family in jazz**, and its modes are especially prominent in chord-scale teaching. Harmonic minor supplies some important sounds too, particularly **Phrygian dominant**.

Start with **A harmonic minor**:

A–B–C–D–E–F–G♯–A

Compared with natural minor, it raises the seventh, creating a leading tone and the characteristic augmented second **F–G♯**.

Its seven modes use that same collection, heard relative to different roots. The formulas below are measured against the **major scale of each mode's own root**. These are common jazz names, although terminology varies. jazz-guitar-licks....

Degree	Mode	Notes from A harmonic minor	Formula
1	**A harmonic minor**	A B C D E F G♯	1 2 ♭3 4 5 ♭6 7

Degree	Mode	Notes from A harmonic minor	Formula
2	**B Locrian ♮6**	B C D E F G♯ A	1 ♭2 ♭3 4 ♭5 6 ♭7
3	**C Ionian ♯5**	C D E F G♯ A B	1 2 3 4 ♯5 6 7
4	**D Dorian ♯4**	D E F G♯ A B C	1 2 ♭3 ♯4 5 6 ♭7
5	**E Phrygian dominant**	E F G♯ A B C D	1 ♭2 3 4 5 ♭6 ♭7
6	**F Lydian ♯2**	F G♯ A B C D E	1 ♯2 3 ♯4 5 6 7
7	**G♯ ultralocrian**, or super-Locrian ♭♭7	G♯ A B C D E F	1 ♭2 ♭3 ♭4 ♭5 ♭6 ♭♭7

The most immediately useful connection is **A harmonic minor ↔ E Phrygian dominant**. Over an **E7 resolving to Am**, the collection supplies:

- **E–G♯–B–D:** the dominant-seventh chord.
- **F:** its ♭9.
- **C:** its ♭13.
- **G♯ → A:** the leading-tone resolution into the tonic.

That connects directly to our Phrygian discussion: **E Phrygian has G♮; E Phrygian dominant has G♯.** The latter can describe a stable modal color, but it can also describe the dominant region of A minor. The musical context determines its role.

Melodic minor works differently in jazz pedagogy. "Jazz melodic minor" generally means the ascending form used **in both directions**:

A–B–C–D–E–F♯–G♯–A

It is major with a lowered third, or Dorian with a raised seventh. Unlike harmonic minor, it contains no augmented second.

Degree	Mode of A melodic minor	Formula	Typical harmonic application
1	**A melodic minor / jazz minor**	1 2 ♭3 4 5 6 7	Am(maj7), Am6
2	**B Dorian ♭2** / Phrygian ♮6	1 ♭2 ♭3 4 5 6 ♭7	Bsus(♭9), depending on voicing
3	**C Lydian augmented**	1 2 3 ♯4 ♯5 6 7	Cmaj7(♯5)
4	**D Lydian dominant**	1 2 3 ♯4 5 6 ♭7	D7(♯11)

Degree	Mode of A melodic minor	Formula	Typical harmonic application
5	**E Mixolydian ♭6**	1 2 3 4 5 ♭6 ♭7	E7 with ♭13 and natural 9
6	**F♯ Locrian ♮2**	1 2 ♭3 4 ♭5 ♭6 ♭7	F♯m7♭5 with natural 9
7	**G♯ altered / super-Locrian**	1 ♭2 ♭3 ♭4 ♭5 ♭6 ♭7	G♯7alt, with enharmonic respelling

Lydian dominant and altered are particularly important practical resources. Gary Burton's Berklee introduction includes both among his core jazz scales. In dominant-chord language, the altered scale is usually spelled **1–♭9–♯9–3–♭5–♭13–♭7**, making its chord tones easier to recognize. Berklee Online Ta…

One distinction matters throughout: **using a mode as a chord scale doesn't mean the composition is modal.** An improviser might use E Phrygian dominant over E7 in a strongly tonal A-minor progression.

For your visitors, a manageable preview would be three scales on **A**:

Natural minor: A B C D E **F G**
Harmonic minor: A B C D E **F G♯**
Jazz melodic minor: A B C D E **F♯ G♯**

Play the same little melody in each. Two adjustable notes open up three different musical possibilities.

You said:

provide some examples in jazz (songs, recordings, improvisationational styles) build on these rotational modes of minor scales.

Worked for 50s >

ChatGPT said:

Yes—melodic-minor modes give you several strong examples. The useful distinction is between a tune's characteristic harmony and a scale an improviser uses briefly over one chord. We can identify both without claiming an entire recording stays within one collection.

Example to hear	Mode and parent scale	Where the connection occurs
Horace Silver, "Nica's Dream" — his recording on *Horace-Scope*	**B♭ melodic minor and A♭ melodic minor**, each in its first mode	The opening alternates **B♭m(maj7) and A♭m(maj7)**. These sustained minor-major harmonies make an excellent introduction to the melodic-minor sound.

Example to hear	Mode and parent scale	Where the connection occurs
Billy Strayhorn, "Take the 'A' Train" — Duke Ellington Orchestra	**D Lydian dominant**, mode 4 of **A melodic minor**	In the usual concert-C version, **bars 3–4** feature D7 with **G♯ in the melody**, its ♯11. Lydian dominant supplies a useful seven-note environment for that sound.
Joe Henderson, "Inner Urge" — the title track of *Inner Urge*	**F♯ Locrian ♮2**, mode 6 of **A melodic minor**	The opening **F♯m7♭5** area offers a place to hear or demonstrate the natural ninth, **G♯**, against half-diminished harmony. This is an improvisational option, rather than a claim that every phrase uses that scale.

Jordan Klemons explicitly teaches the opening of "Nica's Dream" through the two melodic-minor collections; Ariane Cap identifies the ♯11 in bar 3 of "A Train"; and an analysis of Henderson's playing connects "Inner Urge" with Locrian ♮2. Improvisation +2

For the altered scale—mode 7 of melodic minor—listen to Freddie Hubbard. JazzAdvice identifies an altered-scale phrase at approximately **4:54 in** this performance with McCoy Tyner, Ron Carter, and Elvin Jones. Its analysis, section 6, gives you a specific listening reference. This is the sound of altered dominant tensions inside a moving improvised line. Jazzadvice

A useful demonstration is **G altered → C minor**:

- Play **A♭ melodic minor** over G7: heard from G, that becomes **G altered**.
- Emphasize **A♭ and B♭**—the ♭9 and ♯9—then resolve into C minor.
- Students hear a collection that sounds minor over A♭ become a tense dominant sound over G.

For harmonic minor's fifth mode, "Caravan" is a useful starting point. Its prolonged dominant area invites Phrygian-dominant treatment. For an explicitly documented example, trombonist **Charles Neuzil's** "Caravan" performance and explanation identifies that approach, while also describing his microtonal alteration of the third. That makes it an example of a performer adapting the collection.

Charles Neuzil

For your own exploration, **"Nica's Dream" → "A Train" → Hubbard's altered phrase** is the strongest sequence: minor-major color, dominant ♯11 color, then altered dominant tension. The harmonic-minor modes beyond the first and fifth are less useful as an initial listening syllabus; I wouldn't force a famous-tune example onto every rotation.

You said:

describe messiaen's 3rd mode of limited transposition and which of his piece's or others draws specifically from it

Worked for 25s >

ChatGPT said:

Messiaen's Mode 3 is a nine-note collection built by repeating "whole step–half step–half step" three times. One form is:

C–D–E♭–E–F♯–G–A♭–B♭–B–C

Its pattern is **2–1–1 | 2–1–1 | 2–1–1**, measured in semitones. Each group spans a major third:

Group	Notes
First	C–D–E♭–E
Second	E–F♯–G–A♭
Third	A♭–B♭–B–C

The groups share their boundary notes, giving **nine distinct pitches**, plus the repeated octave.

Why only four transpositions? Transpose the collection up a major third—four semitones—and you get the original pitch classes again. Thus, starting at transpositions 0, 1, 2, and 3 gives four distinct collections; transposition 4 duplicates the first. Messiaen illustrates the four forms in *The Technique of My Musical Language*, examples 329–332. music-comp.gith...

A useful way to hear its harmonic possibilities is to play **both major and minor triads on C, E, and A♭**. All six chords fit inside the collection. That gives you familiar consonant objects connected through an unfamiliar, symmetrical pitch environment. Their voicing, register, and succession determine whether the result sounds luminous, unsettled, or densely chromatic.

For specific repertoire:

Work	Where Mode 3 enters
Messiaen, Prélude No. 5, "Les sons impalpables du rêve…"	**The opening right-hand chordal figures use Mode 3**, superimposed on a left-hand chordal theme using Mode 2. This is a particularly useful example of modes functioning simultaneously as harmonic layers. Pianist Angela Hewitt explicitly identifies this combination in her performance notes.
Alexander Tcherepnin, *Romantic Sonatina*, Op. 4	Tcherepnin identifies this 1918 work as the first appearance of his **nine-step scale**, the same collection family as Messiaen's Mode 3, although organized and explained differently.
Tcherepnin, *Twelve Preludes for Cello and Piano*, Op. 34	The composer explicitly describes the cycle as exploring his twelve nine-step "tonalities"—his system of modal and tonal-center distinctions within the symmetrical collections.

For the Messiaen example, see Hewitt's notes; for the Tcherepnin works, we have the composer's own account. Tcherepnin's technical explanation also makes clear that his terminology differs from Messiaen's. Portland Piano In… +2

For your Prelude Day demonstration, I'd play a four-note figure **C–D–E♭–E**, repeat it up a major third, then up another major third. You have traversed the whole collection through three identical gestures. Follow that with the six major/minor triads, then a short excerpt from the fifth Prélude.

That gives students something concrete to recognize: **a repeating pattern can generate both a scale and an entire harmonic world.** The recording then shows how Messiaen combines that resource with another mode, rather than simply writing a melody that runs through nine notes.

You said:

can you find an example in jazz or popular music of messiaen's 3rd mode, or any of the modes 3 or higher?

Worked for 21s

ChatGPT said:

Yes—Allan Holdsworth is a strong jazz-fusion connection, and I found an especially clear film-score example of Mode 3. The evidence differs between them:

1. Allan Holdsworth, "Countdown," on *None Too Soon* — Mode 3 as an improvisational resource

Guitarist Brett Stine's transcription and analysis of Holdsworth's introduction identifies Mode 3 as a likely organizing collection, especially in the opening measures and later symmetrical passages.

This is Stine's analytical interpretation, rather than a statement by Holdsworth about that particular solo. It nevertheless gives you a specific recording and passages to investigate. brettstinemusic

There's a useful connection to Coltrane here. This Mode 3 collection:

C D E♭ E F♯ G A♭ B♭ B

contains the major triads **C, E, A♭, G, B, and E♭**—the tonic and dominant triads associated with the three major-third-related centers **C, E, and A♭**. That helps explain its usefulness around Coltrane changes. **Containing those triads doesn't mean that "Giant Steps" itself stays within Mode 3**, however.

2. Brett Stine, "Messiaen's 3rd Mode—Lesson & Étude" — an explicit fusion-style demonstration

This is the clearest controlled listening example I found: Stine states that **no notes outside Mode 3 occur in his piece**. His page includes notation and a performance, letting you connect the collection directly to guitar voicings and moving harmony.

Lesson, score, and explanation · Performance. It is a teaching étude, rather than an established jazz standard. brettstinemusic.n...

3. Mac Quayle, *Leave the World Behind* (2023) — Mode 3 throughout a film score

This extends your search into popular screen media. **Quayle explicitly says he used Mode 3 to compose the entire score.** He describes its three excluded pitches as a constraint that forced him to change his habitual harmonic movements, creating the slightly unfamiliar, unsettling effect he wanted.

That is direct composer testimony, making it a particularly strong example. See the interview's discussion of the nine-note collection. We Are Movie Ge...

For Friday, I'd use Stine for a clearly audible demonstration, or Quayle for the broader connection: a symmetrical scale can become the pitch vocabulary of a contemporary thriller. I haven't verified an equally strong mainstream pop-song example—or a specific commercial recording using Modes 4–7—from the sources checked.

You said:

i'll probably just use so what, love ridden, and an example of messiaen mode 3. give me other messiaen excerpts that use mode 3

Worked for 1s >

You said:

what mode is used in liturgie du cristal?

Worked for 50s >

ChatGPT said:

“Liturgie de cristal” uses several collections simultaneously, including Mode 3. It’s a good example of Messiaen layering different pitch resources.

Instrument/layer	Pitch material
Cello	**Mode 1—the whole-tone collection.** Its repeating five-pitch sequence is **C–E–D–F♯–B♭**, omitting A♭ from the complete scale.
Piano	A repeating **29-chord sequence** combining several harmonic resources. **Chords 16–21 use Mode 3, third transposition**; other portions use Mode 2 and diatonic harmonies with appoggiaturas.
Clarinet and violin	Birdsong figures with changing pitch materials. The clarinet’s rising flourish in the **first two bars at rehearsal G** joins forms of Modes **1, 2, and 3**.

The piano’s Mode 3 segment is identified in Eric Brahinsky’s analysis; Anthony Pople also describes its six-chord grouping and the cello and clarinet materials. ericbrahinsky.com +2

For your lesson, you can use it, but isolate the piano passage first. Otherwise, the surrounding layers make it difficult for students to hear a single nine-note collection.

Another useful excerpt from the same quartet is **movement II, “Vocalise, pour l’Ange qui annonce la fin du Temps”: the ascending string runs at rehearsal C, bars 1–2, use Mode 3**, returning as descending runs at **H, bars 1–2**. That offers a more exposed melodic demonstration. DOKUMEN.PUB

You said:

i need a firm example of mode 3 in isolation from others within messiaen's output

Worked for 1m 14s >

ChatGPT said:

Use the opening theme of Messiaen's *Thème et variations* for violin and piano (1932), measures 1–14. Both instruments stay within **Mode 3, first transposition**:

C–D–E♭–E–F♯–G–A♭–B♭–B

This gives you the firm example you need: **melody and accompaniment share the same nine-note collection.** Phoebe Rousochatzaki's analysis explicitly identifies measures 1–14 as Mode 3[1]; the music changes to Mode 2 at measure 15. **Cue the recording from the beginning and stop before that change.** researchcatalogu...

There is also direct confirmation from Messiaen for a passage **in the first variation**: *The Technique of My Musical Language*, **example 339**, reproduces six measures for violin and piano, about which he writes:

> "This fragment does not leave the notes of the mode in its first transposition."

You can view that score excerpt here. PDF

For Friday, I'd choose the opening theme. Its clear melody and chordal accompaniment will make it easier to connect your keyboard demonstration of the collection with an actual piece. My earlier layered examples didn't meet your requirement for isolation; this passage does.